

PHILOSOPHY ORIENTATION CAMP

CUHK · 26th Camp · 2026

ENGLISH TRANSLATION EDITION

Original Chinese edition preserved separately.

TEAM & ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

Shun (Lee Kwok-shun) — Camp President. Overall coordination; itinerary and activity design; venue and accommodation bookings; meal orders; anti-sexual-harassment officer.

Wisdom (Chuk Tai-wai) — Vice-President. Game design; booklet production; catering; financial management; administrative liaison; emotional-support officer.

Danny (Chui Ka-yeung) — Previous Camp President; current Executive Committee. Advice based on prior experience; group naming; meal orders.

Rex (Lee Yi-hang) — Previous Vice-President; current Executive Committee. Departmental Society Instagram; promotion; camp T-shirt; general support.

Peggy (Lee Pak-yi) — Organising Committee; anti-sexual-harassment officer.

Group mentors — Ruf, Ng Ka-faat, Minkai, Jacky and Arthur (group dads); Kiu-je, Leona, Sheena and Mavis (group mums). Kiu-je also served as an emotional-support officer.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

Administrative support: Ivy (Ling Pui-ye) and Kit (Tsang Sze-kei)

Faculty advisers: Lau Po-hei and Meng Fanlin

Teacher–student gathering, first-day catering, meal and transport arrangements

CAMP SCHEDULE

17–19 AUGUST 2026

DAY 1 · MONDAY, 17 AUGUST

10:30 Meet at YIA Ground Floor

10:30–11:30 Opening briefing + anti-sexual-harassment talk · YIA 503

11:30–12:30 Check in and leave luggage · Lee Woo Sing College hostel

12:30–13:00 Walk to Fung King Hey Building

13:00–14:30 Lunch and teacher–student gathering · Fung King Hey G/F

14:30–16:30 Games · Fung King Hey G/F

16:30–17:30 Return to hostel and room allocation

17:30–18:00 Walk to Chung Chi Tang

18:00–19:00 Dinner · Chung Chi Tang

19:00 onward Hostel activities

DAY 2 · TUESDAY, 18 AUGUST

10:30–11:00 Mental-health talk · ARC G04

11:00–12:00 Lunch · Chung Chi Tang

12:30–15:00 Games · ERB 804

15:00–18:00 CU Hunt

18:00–19:00 Dinner · Chung Chi Tang

19:00 onward Hostel activities

DAY 3 · WEDNESDAY, 19 AUGUST

09:30 Check out

10:45 Walk to Chung Chi Tang

11:00–12:00 Lunch · Chung Chi Tang

12:00–14:00 Shared-reading session · YIA 502

14:00–16:30 Games · YIA 502

16:30–17:00 Closing ceremony + group photo · YIA 502

17:00 Dismissal

CAMP PRESIDENT

Shun



A SUDDEN BLOW, THAUMAZEIN, AND THE WAY

My path into philosophy began with a sudden blow. In Professor Cheng Chung-yi's History of Chinese Philosophy class, the very first lesson opened with: "Treat this as the first course in your life for which you have truly studied." I was jolted. Apparently, more than ten years of "studying" had not yet counted.

The sudden blow comes from Chan Buddhism: Deshan's staff and Linji's shout. One strike, and delusion shatters. That semester did this to me. The scattered "thoughts" in my head—what Confucius said, what Zhuangzi said—were drawn into a line, with a lineage and a sense of problems. "Thought" became "philosophy". Plato says philosophy begins in wonder (thaumazein): a crack opened in the familiar world. The culture in which I lived contained an entire unknown.

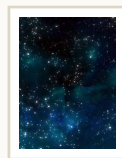
Call that line, provisionally, the Way. Dao originally means a path: one made by predecessors and open for later travellers. Confucius has his way; Laozi has his. In the end, philosophy asks one question: where is your way?

In three days and two nights you will not master Kant or fathom Zhuangzi. But your own sudden blow may be waiting somewhere in this department—in a lecture hall, a late-night conversation, or an offhand remark from a group mentor. May a crack also open in your familiar world during these three days.

Welcome to the Department of Philosophy. — Shun, Camp President · August 2026

INSTAGRAM

Wisdom



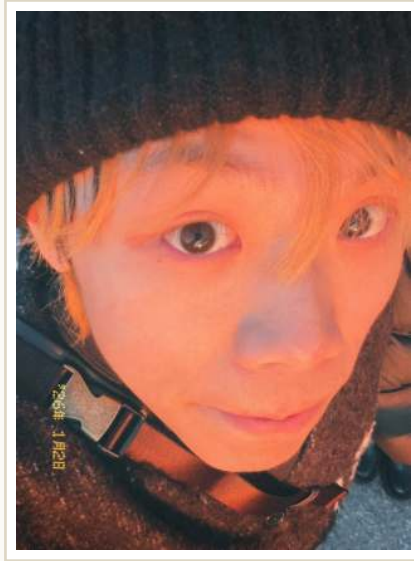
Thank you, Shun, for stepping in when I was going through my most difficult period. Without you, this orientation camp would not have happened.

Thank you, Danny and Rex. As last year's Camp President and Vice-President, you still volunteered to help, sharing much hard-won advice and helping us avoid many detours. Thank you to every group mentor: you stayed to the present, wrote sincere messages for the new students, kept them company, listened to their worries and confusion, and talked with them. Thank you to the Department office, and to Ivy and Kit for administrative support and continued care. Thank you for your advice on team matters; it helped us enormously. Thank you to Lau Po-hei and Professor Meng Fanlin—two senior schoolmates from twenty years earlier—for helping us refine the details. Thank you for your concern for the students. Thank you to the Department of Philosophy, JCNSSO and other University units for their support and sponsorship.

Thank you for every contribution, whether or not it was visible. Without any one of you, this camp could not have run smoothly.

Finally, thank you to the new students for joining us. I hope these three days and two nights leave you with a memory that belongs to the relationships formed here.

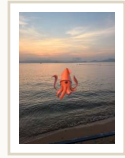
Danny



My full name is Andy Lau · George · Andrew · Marino · Paolo · Leo · William ·
Danny I.

(I hope everyone will call me by my full name.)

Rex · “Squid”



“Squid” is a colloquial umbrella term for many decapod molluscs with long, tapered soft bodies, large eyes, eight arms and two tentacles. They are found mainly among myopsids, oegopsids and deep-sea squid. More broadly within the subclass Coleoidea, many other molluscs are also commonly called squid even when they do not perfectly match that description. Squid are among the most numerous cephalopods and vary enormously in size: some are only as large as a human palm (for example, pencil squid), while the largest can approach the length of a sperm whale (for example, the colossal squid).

Peggy



Life will not always leave you in a low valley; sometimes it takes you to Bangkok.

(A Cantonese wordplay on “valley”.)

Ruf



What kind of era is 2026?

China and the United States remain in confrontation, competing for strategic resources—rare earths, uranium, computing power—and preparing for future contests. AI has become a dinner-table topic. Large language models are the technology that marks our period and the form of AI most people encounter. A human-made system that predicts the next token is beginning to shape our lives; at the very least, global trends compel everyone to learn about AI. I also wonder whether, in scholarship, we might use AI in a way that betrays ourselves. I hope not.

Seeking knowledge involves risk. Enter the corridor of thought and you surrender comfort to reason and reasons. Confusion may become familiar because beliefs keep shifting. You must humbly accept that there may be no simple answer—or that the answer may be simple. Reason and curiosity will guide you from here, towards light or towards a fall.

Some philosophers answered an inner call by founding institutions that make it possible for us to study at CUHK today. Others accepted conclusions they found absurd and abandoned traditional laws of logic, then built a school from that unease. We may never fully grasp the weight of such commitments. That is perhaps fitting: studying philosophy is not a choice made in search of ease.

Please attend to your mental health. Many students, including me, have felt lost and anxious on the philosophical path. That is normal, but not easy. In Hong Kong's capital-centred society, people struggle to create value in exchange for love and security. Others—even a partner—may question or belittle what you do. Seeing a counsellor is not shameful: it is a free resource that gives you a listener, something that often costs money outside the University.

Orientation messages usually try to stay light. Here I hope to add a little weight: may fellow travellers at New Asia feel the weight of history and the present age, while still enjoying university life and, in future, the horizon you frame for yourself.

Listen to the call. I hope we have the good fortune to meet and encourage one another in this era.

GROUP MENTOR

Ng Ka-faat



You've got this.

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GROUP MENTOR

Minkai



Question what seems beyond doubt; where doubt arises, seek understanding.

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GROUP MENTOR

Jacky



I hope you enjoy your four years at CUHK. University is a place full of freedom and possibility: you can choose to study, serve on a student society, or go on exchange. This journey offers many chances to put your own ideas into practice—so remember to enjoy it to the fullest.

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GROUP MENTOR

Arthur



Life is short. Enjoy the present while you can.

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Kiu-je



Congratulations on joining CUHK Philosophy! I hope your next four years are rich and rewarding—whether through what you learn in philosophy and other subjects, personal growth and breakthroughs, friendships, love, or widening your social world. May every happy moment become a lasting memory.

GROUP MENTOR

Leona · “Sweet Potato”



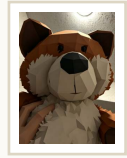
Drink more books; read more water.

(The original deliberately swaps the usual verbs as a playful reminder to keep learning and stay hydrated.)

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GROUP MENTOR

Sheena



I entered CUHK Philosophy almost by accident. For two years I often did not know where the future would lead. Philosophy did not solve my life, but it gave me room to think when everything felt chaotic.

In the years ahead, you may feel lost, take detours, or even lose control. Do not stop thinking—and do not merely recite other people's ideas in place of reaching your own conclusions.

I hope that when you look back a few years from now, you will have gained the professional habits of a philosophy student and will also have become a philosopher in your own right.

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GROUP MENTOR

Mavis



It is a pleasure to meet you during these three days and two nights! I hope I can help make this a good trip for everyone.

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FACULTY AT A GLANCE

Roles and research areas in the original booklet

Saulius Geniusas	Professor · Chair	Continental philosophy; phenomenology; hermeneutics
Lau Chong-fuk	Professor · Faculty/Division Head	Kant; Hegel; metaphysics
Cheng Chung-yi	Professor · MA Programme Director	Chinese philosophy; Confucian philosophy
Yao Zhihua	Professor	Buddhist, Indian and religious philosophy; phenomenology
Zhong Lei	Professor	Philosophy of mind; Daoist philosophy; metaphysics
Zhang Qibao	Professor	Philosophy of science; formal epistemology; philosophica
David Chai	Associate Professor	Ancient and medieval Chinese philosophy
Gregory Moss	Associate Professor	Metaphysics; epistemology; post-Kantian German philosoph
Leung Ka-wing	Associate Professor	Phenomenology; Nietzsche; Brentano
Cheng Chak-ming	Associate Professor	Song–Ming thought; Chinese philosophy; ethics
Ye Ru	Associate Professor	Epistemology; decision theory; philosophy of science
Hayden Kee	Assistant Professor	Continental and environmental philosophy; phenomenology;
Meng Fanlin	Assistant Professor	Social-political, comparative philosophy and ethics
Nicholas Rimell	Assistant Professor	Metaphysics; philosophy of mind; ethics
Law Tin-kwan	Assistant Professor	Metaphysics; philosophy of religion
Yeung Tak-lap	Research Assistant Professor	Kant; Arendt; Heidegger; comparative and cross-cultural
Ko Kei-chuen	Senior Lecturer	Epistemology; logic
Kwok Pak-nin	Senior Lecturer	Normative and applied ethics; life and death
Lau Po-hei	Senior Lecturer	Confucianism; modern Chinese and comparative philosophy
Wong Yiu-hong	Lecturer	Phenomenology; hermeneutics
Chong Yun-chak	Lecturer	Qing Confucianism; post-conventional ethics

CURRICULUM STRUCTURE

Four-year undergraduate Philosophy programme

Faculty requirements (including PHIL1110)	9 units
Major required courses	30 units
Major electives	24 units
Minor / free electives	18–30 units
Chinese language	5 units
English language	8 units
General education	21 units
Digital literacy and computational thinking	3 units
Physical education	2 units
TOTAL	AT LEAST 123 UNITS

REQUIRED PHILOSOPHY COURSES

PHIL1110 Introduction to Philosophy; PHIL1310 Logic; PHIL2020–2030 History of Chinese Philosophy I–II; PHIL2040–2050 History of Western Philosophy I–II; PHIL2060 Philosophy and Human Existence; PHIL3000 Ethics; PHIL3800 Metaphysics; PHIL3820 Epistemology; PHIL4800 Capstone Course.

MAJOR ELECTIVE AREAS

Area 1: Chinese / Eastern philosophy (at least 6 units)

Area 2: Western philosophy (at least 6 units)

Area 3: Philosophical problems (at least 6 units)

STARTER READING

1 Thomas Nagel, What Does It All Mean?

A concise introduction to major philosophical problems, including knowledge, free will, right and wrong, and the meaning of life.

2 Mou Zongsan, Nineteen Lectures on Chinese Philosophy

Developed from Mou's later oral lectures; comparatively approachable and focused on the central insights of Chinese philosophy, especially Daoism.

3 Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy

A free, peer-reviewed online reference in English. Entries are written and revised by specialists. It is often more reliable than general web summaries for concepts and philosophers.

[PLATO.STANFORD.EDU](https://plato.stanford.edu)

TRANSFER INTO PHILOSOPHY

Application period: approximately June each year (once annually).

Eligibility — meet any one condition:

1. Completed or provisionally enrolled in 6 units of major courses, with an average grade of at least B-.
2. Admission score was above the bottom 10% of the target programme's intake in that year.
3. Current CGPA is at least 3.0.

To explore another major, students may ask Philosophy to withdraw from some current-programme courses and use the released units for target-programme courses, helping satisfy condition 1. Always verify current rules with the University.

USEFUL LINKS I

Department of Philosophy

Department website

[OPEN LINK](#)

Course list / timetable

[OPEN LINK](#)

Scholarships

[OPEN LINK](#)

Programme structure

[OPEN LINK](#)

Study scheme · Chinese PDF

[OPEN LINK](#)

Study scheme · English PDF

[OPEN LINK](#)

Undergraduate handbook

[OPEN LINK](#)

Course search

[OPEN LINK](#)

The cards above are clickable. External pages and programme rules may change; use official CUHK sources as the authority.

USEFUL LINKS II

Practical university information

Core requirements

[OPEN LINK](#)

University general education

[OPEN LINK](#)

College general education

[OPEN LINK](#)

Chinese / English exemptions

[OPEN LINK](#)

Faculty courses

[OPEN LINK](#)

Other minors

[OPEN LINK](#)

Declare a second major

[OPEN LINK](#)

Typhoon / rainstorm classes

[OPEN LINK](#)

Library opening hours

[OPEN LINK](#)

CUHK campus map

[OPEN LINK](#)

CUHK shortcut · video

[OPEN LINK](#)

CUHK shortcut · map

[OPEN LINK](#)

All cards are clickable. Some linked documents are maintained only in Chinese by the University.

PREVENTING SEXUAL HARASSMENT

The University is committed to eliminating and preventing sexual harassment. Sexual harassment by staff or students is not tolerated.

Sexual harassment includes any unwelcome sexual language, conduct or physical contact. An intimidating, hostile or threatening environment related to sex can also constitute sexual harassment. It can occur between people of the same or different sexes. A single incident may be sufficient.

IF YOU EXPERIENCE SEXUAL HARASSMENT

1. Tell the person that the conduct is unacceptable.
2. Record what happened, including the nature of the incident, date, time, place and witnesses.
3. Seek emotional support.
4. If the conduct continues, contact the University or an appropriate organisation.

CAMP CONTACTS

Anti-sexual-harassment officers: Peggy (Lee Pak-yi) and Shun (Lee Kwok-shun).

Emotional-support officers: Kiu-je and Wisdom (Chuk Tai-wai).

CUHK Committee Against Discrimination and Sexual Harassment hotline: 3943 8716.

SAFE, RESPECTFUL, AND SUPPORTIVE

If anyone is in immediate danger, contact emergency services.

EMERGENCY CONTACTS

999

Police · Fire · Ambulance

3943 7999

CUHK Campus Security · 24 hours

5400 2055

CUHK Emotional Support Hotline · 24 hours

3943 6422

University Health Service · office hours

CAMP LEADS

Camp President: Shun

Vice-President: Wisdom

CREDITS

Booklet content — All team members

Cover and background artwork — Shun (Lee Kwok-shun)

Booklet production — Wisdom (Chuk Tai-wai)

English translation edition — prepared for bilingual access, with names, roles and original authorship retained

This edition translates the 2026 Chinese/Cantonese orientation-camp booklet. In any discrepancy, the original Chinese edition and current official CUHK information should be treated as authoritative.